

ANIMALS IN DANGER

Labord's chameleon

⚠️ IUCN status: vulnerable

📊 Population estimate: unknown

Elongate leaf chameleon

⚠️ IUCN status: vulnerable

📊 Population estimate: unknown

Parson's chameleon

⚠️ IUCN status: near threatened

📊 Population estimate: unknown

Panther chameleon

Male panther chameleons vary a great deal in color depending on where they live. Some are red, green, and yellow, others are turquoise-green or grayish. Most females are pinkish-brown.



Chameleon colors

Chameleons have a famous ability to change color, usually according to their mood. A male panther chameleon switches to an especially bright pattern when showing off to potential mates or competing males. The color change comes from tiny crystals in the skin that reflect light in different ways.



Parson's chameleon

In some chameleons, such as the Parson's chameleon, the males have prominent horns on their nose, which they use in "jousting" contests when defending territory.

Body shape

A chameleon's body has flat sides, making its high-arched back look like a crest running from head to tail. Green or brown colors help hide chameleons among leaves.

Feet for gripping

The five toes of a chameleon foot are fused together into two mitten-like pads. This unique arrangement helps them hold on tightly to any branch.

Parson's chameleon

Prehensile tail

Chameleons are among the very few lizards with completely prehensile tails. This means they can use their tail like a fifth limb to grip branches as they climb through trees.

Mini chameleon

The world's smallest chameleon, known only by its scientific name of *Brookesia micra*, is also one of the smallest reptiles in the world. It can grow to just 1½ in (3 cm) long, tail included, and spends its life among leaf litter. It was discovered on the tiny islet of Nosy Hara off the north coast of Madagascar.

